Glucora Health

Needle-free glucose monitoring with AI-guided insulin and nutrition coaching

Legal form: GmbH (Munich, DE) **Founded:** 2023 **Employees:** 34

Stage: Series A (EUR 14 M, closed Q2 2026) **Contact:** Business Development, Glucora Health

1. Executive summary

Glucora Health develops **Glucora One**, a wearable patch that estimates interstitial glucose through the skin with a microneedle-free optical and electrochemical sensor, paired with a mobile app that gives AI-based insulin-dosing and meal recommendations. The product targets people with type 1 diabetes and insulin-treated type 2 diabetes who find current continuous glucose monitors (CGM) painful, expensive or hard to interpret.

We plan to open our **European headquarters and R&D centre in Switzerland** in 2027, and are evaluating Canton Bern as the location. We want to be close to clinical diabetes research, medical engineering, and the Swiss regulatory and reimbursement system.

What we are looking for in Bern

- Clinical partners for a 300-patient validation study of sensor accuracy (MARD) against reference blood glucose.
- Research groups in **continuous glucose monitoring, closed-loop / artificial pancreas** systems and diabetes technology.
- Expertise in **AI for nutrition and carbohydrate estimation** from meal photos, and in medical machine learning.
- Biomedical engineering know-how in **wearable biosensors**, skin-sensor interfaces and signal processing.
- Access to lab infrastructure for biocompatibility tests and usability studies.

2. Problem

- Around 500,000 people in Switzerland live with diabetes; about 40,000 have type 1 diabetes.
- Current CGMs need a filament under the skin, cost CHF 1,200–2,000 per year, and must be replaced every 10–14 days.
- Many users get raw glucose curves but no clear advice on what to eat or how much insulin to take. Hypoglycaemia at night is still a major fear for patients and families.

3. Solution and technology

Glucora One patch

- Reusable optical-electrochemical sensor head, 21-day adhesive patch.
- Target accuracy: MARD below 10% (current prototype: 11.8% in a 42-patient pilot).
- Bluetooth Low Energy, open interface to insulin pumps (iCGM-ready).

Glucora Coach app

- Glucose forecast 30–60 minutes ahead with hypo alerts.
- Meal photo → carbohydrate estimate → bolus suggestion.
- Clinician dashboard for remote follow-up; data hosted in Switzerland.

Core IP: two granted patents on the optical sensing method (EP, US), one pending patent on the signal-fusion algorithm.

4. Market

Segment	Size	Comment
Global CGM market 2025	USD 12 bn	Growing ~15% per year
DACH insulin-treated patients	≈ 2.3 M	First target region
Switzerland, type 1 + insulin-treated type 2	≈ 110,000	Beachhead and reference market

Competitors: established CGM makers (filament-based sensors) and diabetes-management apps without their own sensor. Glucora's advantage is the needle-free sensor *and* the coaching in one product.

5. Business model

Revenue stream	Price	Payer
Glucora One starter kit (sensor head + 2 patches)	CHF 290 one-time	Patient / health insurer
Patch subscription (one every 21 days)	CHF 89 / month	Health insurer (MiGeL listing targeted)
Glucora Coach premium	CHF 9 / month	Patient
Clinician dashboard licence	CHF 2,400 / clinic / year	Hospitals, diabetes clinics
Anonymised research data access	Project-based	Universities, pharma

Channels: diabetes clinics and endocrinologists, patient associations, pharmacies, and insurer partnerships. Gross margin target: 68% at 50,000 active users.

6. Plans for the Swiss site

Function	2027	2029	Profiles
R&D: sensor and signal processing	8	20	Biomedical engineers, physicists
Data science / AI	5	12	ML engineers, clinical data scientists
Clinical affairs & regulatory	3	7	MDR / Swissmedic specialists
Pilot manufacturing (patch assembly)	0	15	Production technicians, quality
HQ functions, sales DACH	4	9	Management, market access
Total	**20**	**63**	

- **Space:** 600 m² offices and labs in 2027, plus 1,200 m² ISO 13485 clean-room space for pilot manufacturing from 2029.
- **Investment:** CHF 9 M over three years (lab equipment, clean room, clinical study).
- **Regulatory path:** CE marking under MDR (class IIb) in 2028, Swissmedic registration, MiGeL reimbursement application.

7. Why we consider Canton Bern

- A strong cluster in **diabetes technology** and digital diabetes care, with links to the university hospital.
- Biomedical engineering research on **AI in health and nutrition**, medical robotics and cardiovascular engineering.
- The federal capital: closeness to Swissmedic, the Federal Office of Public Health and insurers' associations.
- Medtech supplier base and precision manufacturing in the canton; bilingual German/French workforce.
- Open questions for the Economic Development Agency: available lab space, start-up support, tax conditions, work permits for non-EU engineers, and introductions to research partners.

8. Financials (plan)

CHF million	2026	2027	2028	2029
Revenue	0.2	1.1	6.8	19.5
Operating costs	7.4	11.9	16.2	21.0
EBITDA	−7.2	−10.8	−9.4	−1.5
Headcount (group)	34	52	78	110

Funding: Series A covers operations until mid-2027. A Series B of about CHF 30 M is planned for 2027, partly to finance the Swiss site and the pivotal clinical study.

9. Team

- **CEO:** co-founder, 12 years in medical devices, former head of product for an insulin-pump company.
- **CTO:** co-founder, PhD in optical biosensors, 9 publications on non-invasive glucose sensing.
- **Chief Medical Officer:** endocrinologist, 15 years of clinical diabetes care.
- **Head of AI:** PhD in machine learning for time-series forecasting.

Fictional company and figures, created as a demo input for the HackApertus Bern Fit prototype. Any resemblance to real companies is coincidental.